Math 6 - Course Syllabus

Mary, Star of the Sea School | SY 2026-2027 | Dr. Peter Park

Course Description

Math 6 is where math becomes a real scientific tool. Across four quarter themes - Lab Math & Density, Numbers at Universe Scale, Reading the Earth, and Climate Data & Geometry - you will use the same math that scientists use in real labs, on real Hawaiian trails, and in real climate data. Each quarter is paced so the math lands exactly when STEM (science) class needs it.

Textbook: Glencoe Math Volume 1 and 2

Grading Policy

Tests 25% | Quizzes 25% | Homework 30% | Participation 20%

Make-ups & Late Work: Homework is due the next class meeting. Late work earns a maximum of 50% credit; if not turned in after two class meetings, the grade is a zero. Students below 80% on tests may make corrections/retest.

Standardized testing: Students take the STAR assessment in fall, winter, and spring to track math growth. English-language learners take the WIDA assessment as required.

Parent-teacher conferences: Formal conferences after Q1 and Q3 grades post. Additional conferences may be requested by email anytime.

Course Outline by Quarter

Q1 - Lab Math & Density

- Lab Math Foundation: Decimal Ops, Unit Conversions (KHDUdcm), Scientific Notation, Percent Error
- Factors & Multiples; Fraction Division
- Density (m/V) - lands by mid-September for STEM Density Lab

Q2 - Numbers at Universe Scale

- Ratios & Rates; Percents
- Powers of 10 / scale of the universe (deep dive)
- Integers; Coordinate Plane

Q3 - Reading the Earth

- Topographic Maps & Slope; Plate Tectonics & Rates
- Richter Scale & Powers of 10; Radioactive Decay & Half-Life
- Algebraic Expressions; Equations; Percent Composition refresher

Q4 - Climate Data & Geometry

- Statistics & Data Analysis (climate datasets, %-change in CO_2)
- Inequalities; Variables & Relationships
- Area, Surface Area, Volume; Word Problems capstone

Teacher Contact

Dr. Peter Park

Email: ppark@starofthesea.org (please allow up to 24 hours for a response on school days)

Phone: (808) 228-2285

School office: (808) 734-0208

Materials

Provided by the school: textbook, classroom manipulatives, in-class devices.

- Composition notebook
- Pencils, erasers, highlighters
- Notebook paper
- Basic 4-function or scientific calculator
- Folder for handouts

Later in the year: graph paper, ruler/protractor, and small compass for the geometry unit.

Daily Schedule

Please refer to the MSOS Middle School daily bell schedule (hard copy in first-week folder) for exact times. Specials (PE, Music, Art, Library, Chapel) rotate on specific days - see the weekly schedule sent home.

Homework & Study Expectations

Frequency: ~20-30 minutes of math per night (part of the ~60-80 minutes total recommended for grades 6-8), plus a few minutes of math fluency practice (IXL, Khan Academy, or flash cards).

Tips for supporting math at home: Set a consistent, quiet study time and place. Ask your child to explain the problem back to you. Encourage effort on every problem. Contact me early if a topic causes frustration.

Classroom Procedures & Behavior Expectations

The 3 R's: Respect, Responsibility, Readiness.

Positive recognition: Verbal praise, shout-outs, positive Beehively notes home, and class-wide rewards (extra math games, free-choice problems, review-day celebrations).

If expectations aren't met: (1) private check-in and reset, (2) reflection/written response during class, (3) parent contact, (4) family meeting with the principal if needed. The goal is always to redirect and re-teach - not to punish.

Middle School Math Goal

From 6th through 8th grade, we focus on more than just numbers - we work to build strong math skills, boost confidence, and develop critical problem-solving abilities that students can apply in every subject and in everyday life. Our approach combines hands-on activities, real-world applications, and a supportive learning environment where students feel encouraged to take risks, ask questions, and think creatively.

By the time they graduate, our students are not only ready for Algebra and beyond, but they also possess the perseverance, analytical thinking, and resourcefulness they need to thrive in high school and in life.

Schoolwide Learning Expectations (SLEs): Self-Aware, Confident Individuals; Teachable Life-Long Learners; Active Christians; Responsible Citizens.

Technology Use

Beehively (grade portal), Google Classroom (assignments), IXL (skill practice), Khan Academy / YouTube (supplemental video), class iPads/Chromebooks.

Digital citizenship: All device use follows the MSOS Technology Acceptable Usage Policy in the family handbook. Any misuse is handled per the school's AUP.

Room Parent & Parent Volunteers

Chaperoning, guest-speaking, helping with class events (Pi Day, Math Olympics, STEM Fair). Email me - I'll connect you with our room parent. All volunteers must have current safe-environment training on file with the school office.

How to Support Your Child at Home

Consistent routines, praise for effort and strategy, weekly Beehively check with your student, real-world math conversations, and early contact if something is affecting learning.

Final Notes

Thank you for partnering with me this year. Your support at home is the single biggest factor in your child's confidence and success in math.

Class website: https://starofthesea.org/classes/

Parent Acknowledgment: After reviewing this syllabus with your student, please email ppark@starofthesea.org with the subject line "Math 6 Syllabus Reviewed - [Student Name]." Mahalo!